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Smart Library Request Workflow In Servicenow

Problem Statement:

Library request processes in many institutions are manual and inefficient, leading to delays, poor tracking, and communication gaps. Students and staff find it difficult to submit and monitor requests. A Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow automates submissions, approvals, and notifications, ensuring real-time tracking, improved efficiency, and a better user experience overall.

Objective:

The objective of the Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow is to automate library request processes, reduce manual effort, and improve efficiency. It enables users to submit and track requests easily, while helping staff manage approvals, maintain records, and ensure quick, transparent, and organized handling of library resources.

Task Initiation:

Milestone 1: Steps to Create Roles

Activity1: Steps to Create Roles

1. Open ServiceNow

2. Click on All → search for Roles.

3. Click on All → search for Roles.

4. Select User Administration → Roles.

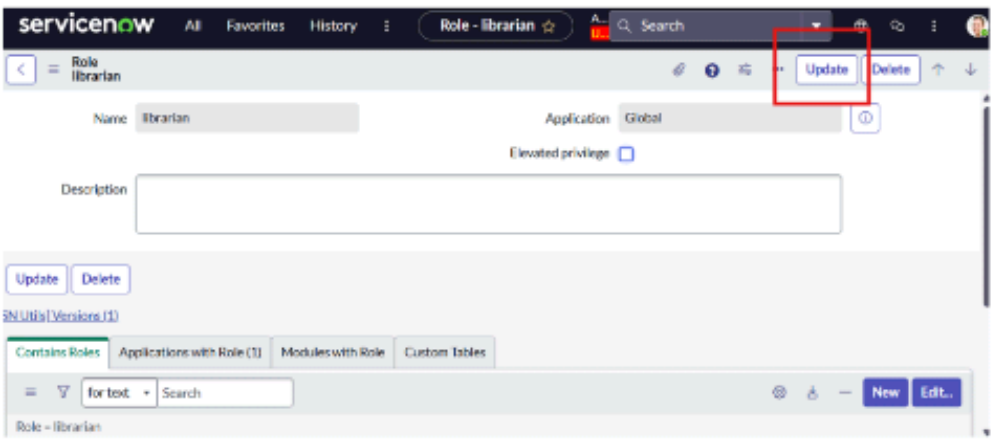
5. Click on New.

6. Enter Role Name as librarian → click Submit.

7. Again, click on New.

8. Enter Role Name as student → click Submit.

9. Verify that both roles (*librarian* and *student*) are listed in the Roles module



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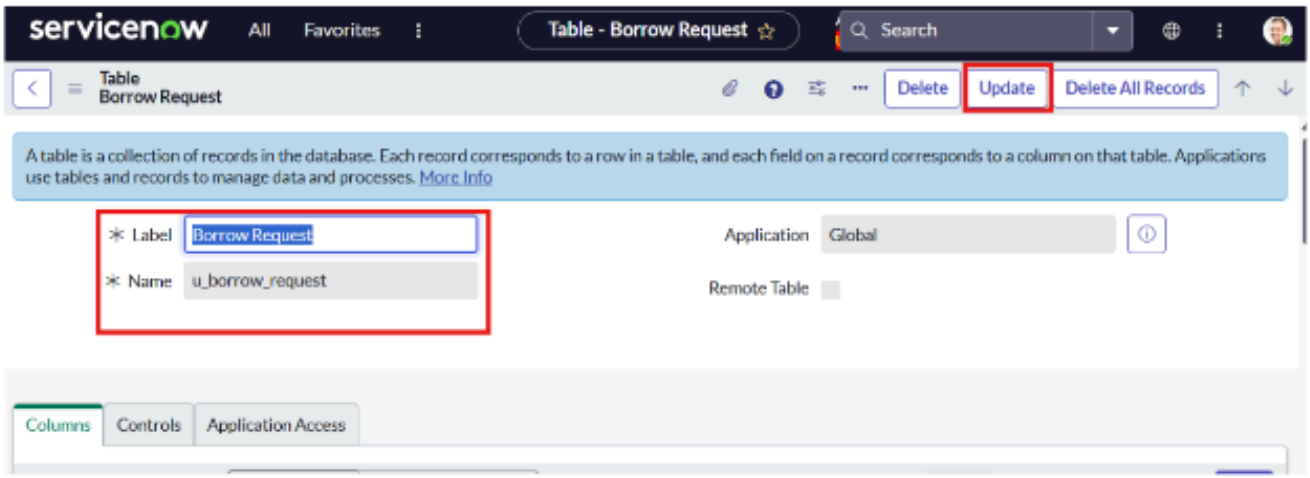
Milestone 2: **Steps to Create Tables**

Activity1: **Table Creation**

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All → search for Tables.
3. Select System Definition → Tables.
4. Click on New.
5. Enter Label as Book → click Submit (this creates the table u_book).
6. Again, click on New.
7. Enter Label as Borrow Request → click Submit (this creates the table u_borrow_request).
8. Verify that both tables (Book and Borrow Request) are listed under the Tables module.



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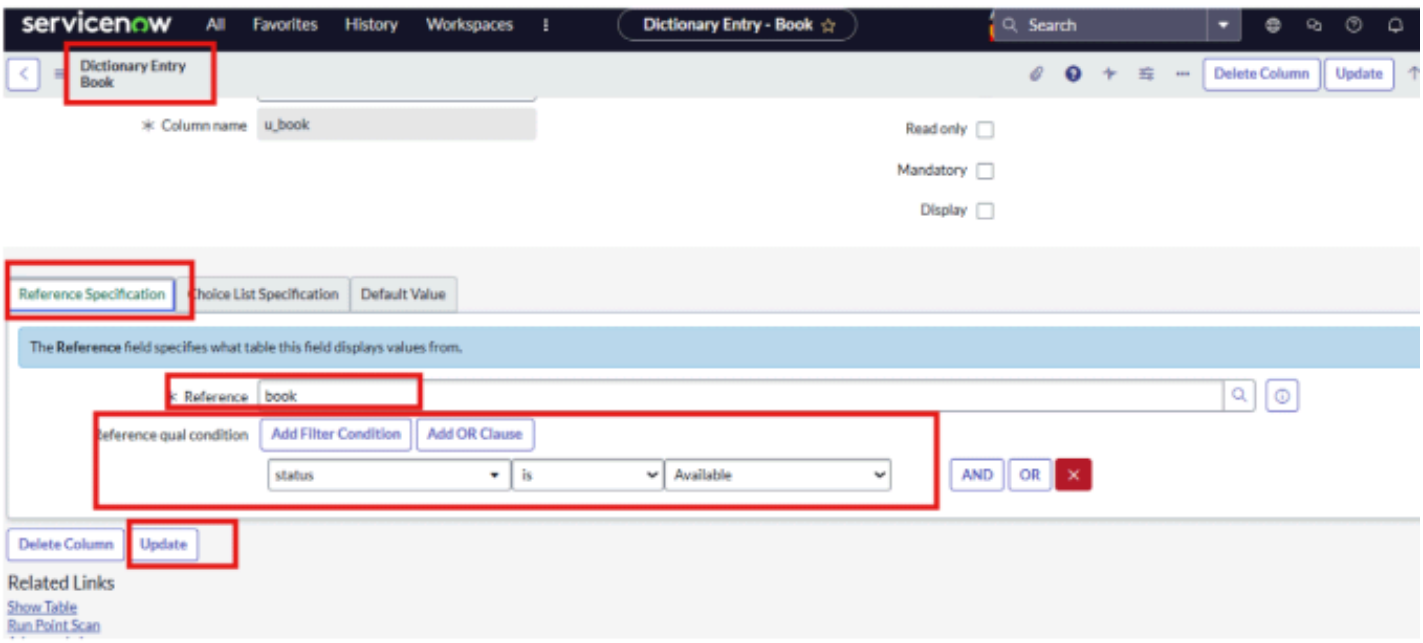
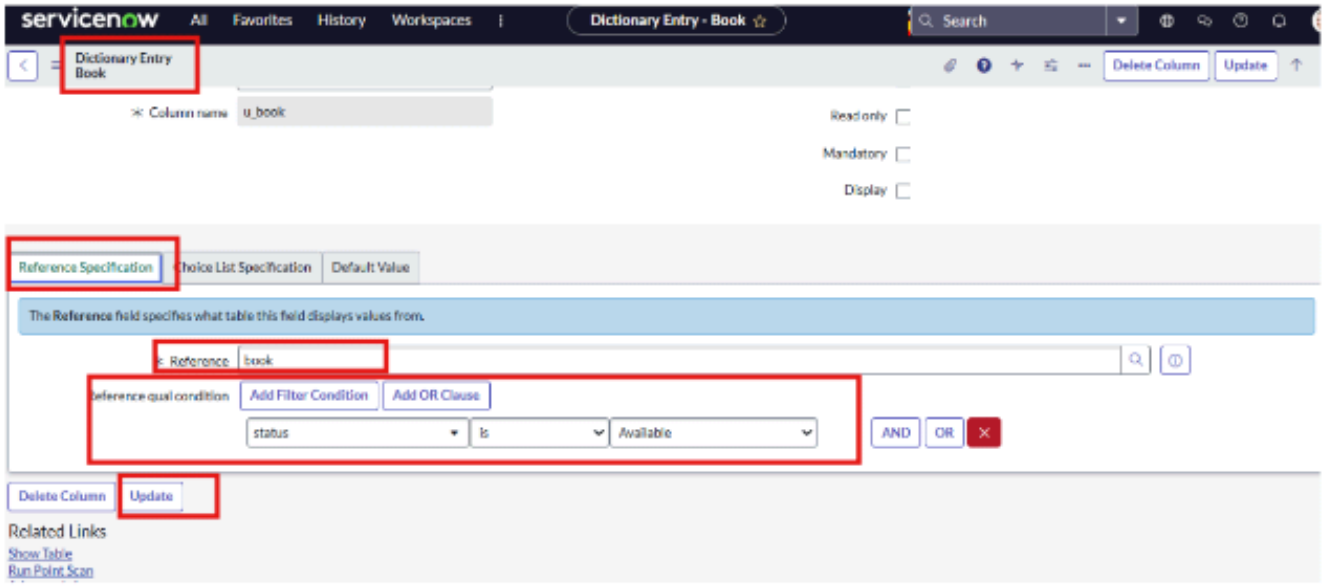
Milestone 3: Configuring Table

Activity1: **Steps to Configure Reference Qualifier (Prevent Requesting Already-Issued Books)**

1. Open ServiceNow and click on All in the Application Navigator.
2. Search for Tables and select System Definition → Tables.
3. From the table list, open Borrow Request [u_borrow_request].
4. Scroll down to the Columns (Dictionary) related list.
5. Locate and open the field Book (Reference field to Book [u_book]).
6. In the field form, switch to Advanced View (click the gear ⚙ icon if Advanced View is not visible).
7. Scroll to the Reference Qualifier section.
8. Select Simple as the Reference Qualifier type.
9. In the Reference Qualifier Condition, set the condition as: Status is Available.
10. Click Update to save the changes.





Milestone4: **Creating Flow Designer**

Activity1: **Steps to Create Flow in Flow Designer (Approve → Issue Book)**

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All → search for Flow Designer.
3. Select Flow Designer and click New → Flow.
4. Enter Name as Borrow Request Approval Flow → click Submit.

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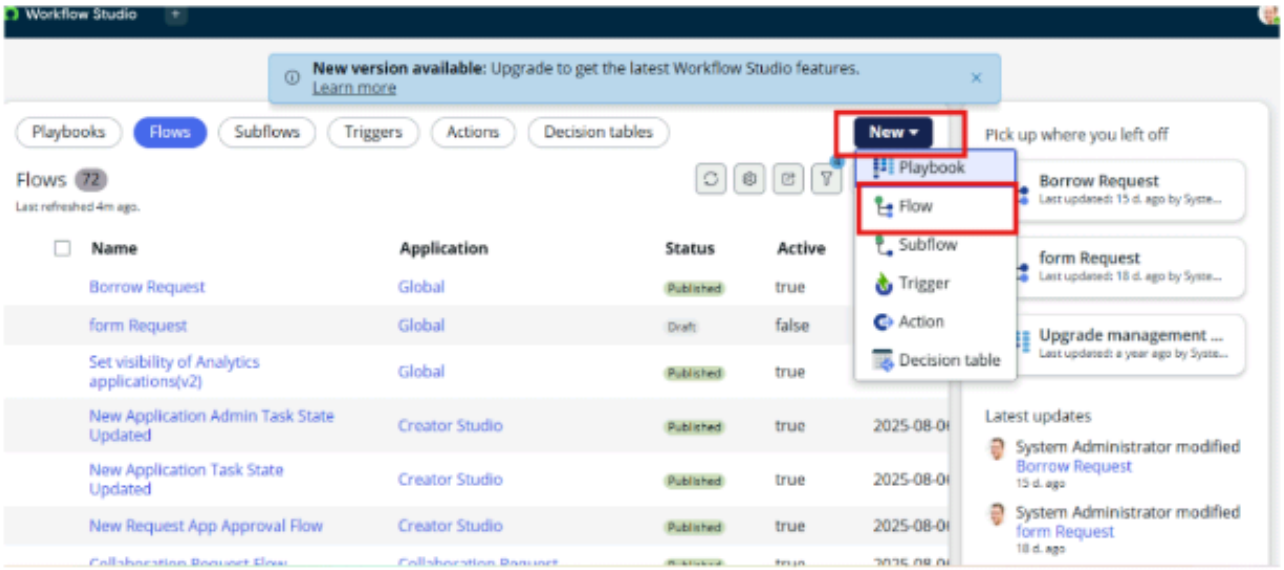

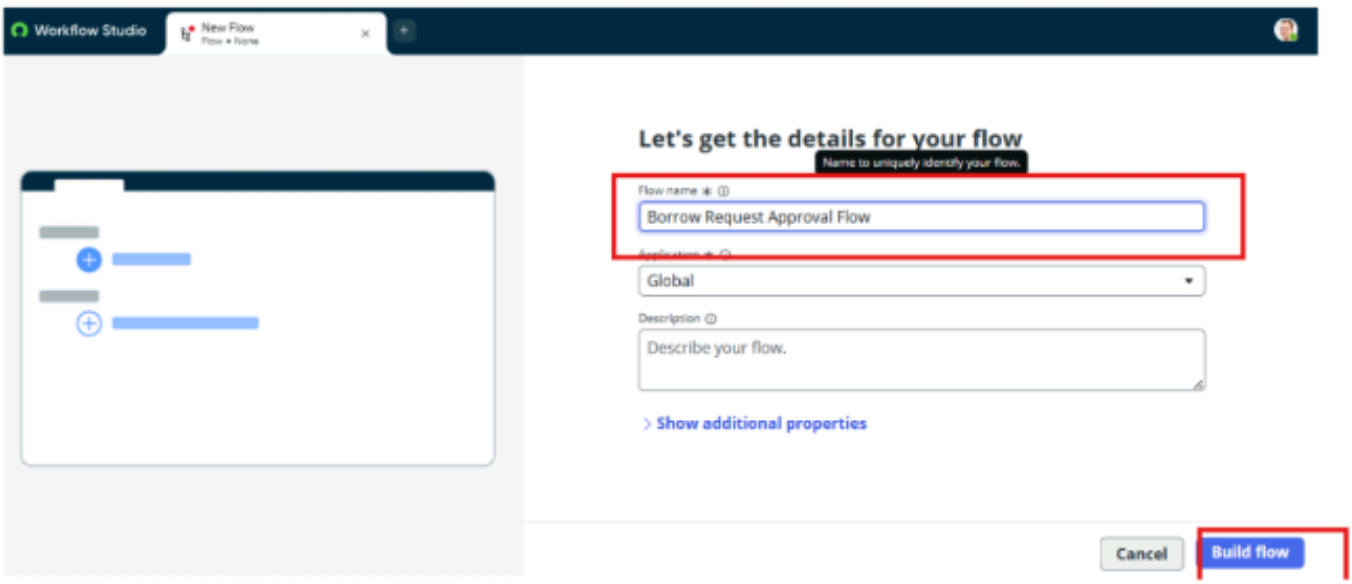

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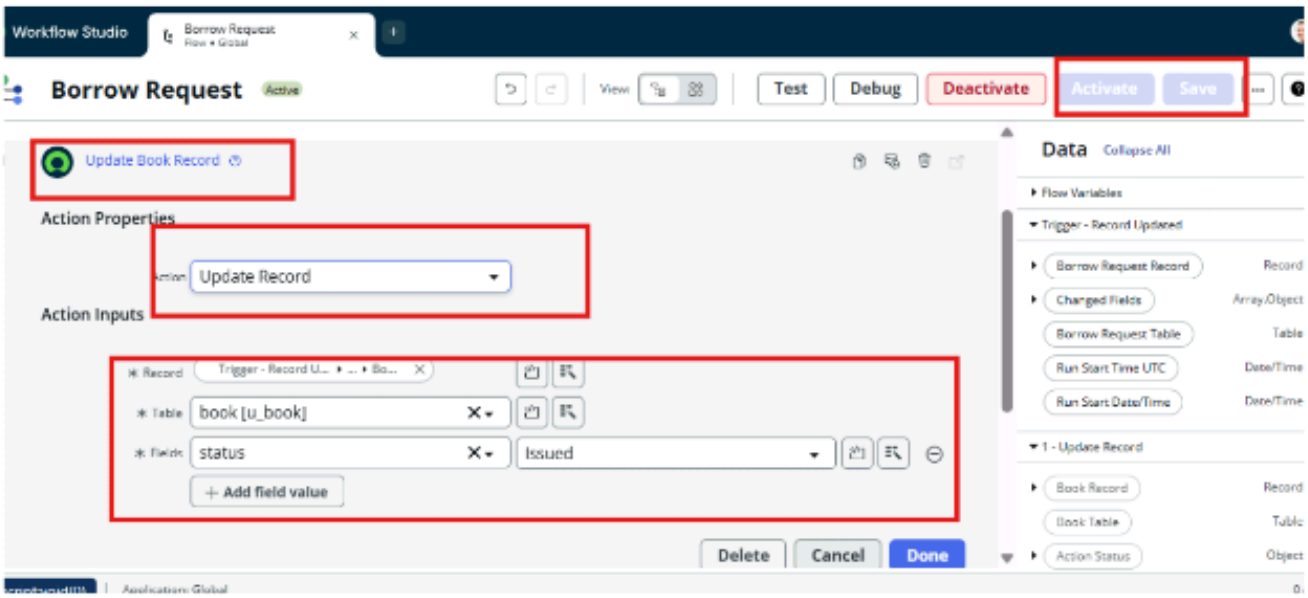
Activity2: **Add Trigger (When to Run the Flow)**

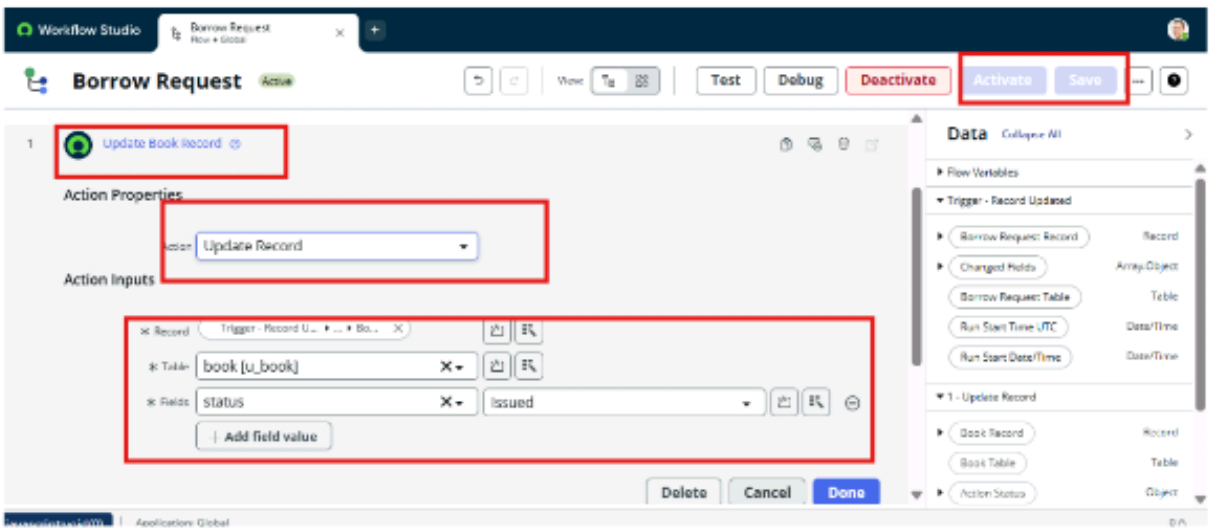
Add Trigger (When to Run the Flow)

1. In the Flow Designer canvas, click + Add Trigger.
2. Select Created or Updated.
3. Choose Table = Borrow Request [u_borrow_request].
4. Add condition: Status = Requested. Click Done.



1. Click on + Add Action.
2. Search for Ask for Approval.
3. Set Approvers = Role: librarian.
4. Approval conditions:
5. On Approve → continue flow.
6. On Reject → set Status = Rejected.
7. Click Done.

4. Add Action – Update Record (Issue Book)
   1. Click on + Add Action.
   2. Search for an Update Record.
   3. Choose Table = Book [u_book].
   4. Condition: Sys ID = Current.Book (the one from Borrow Request)
   5. Set Status = Issued.
   6. Click Done.
   7.



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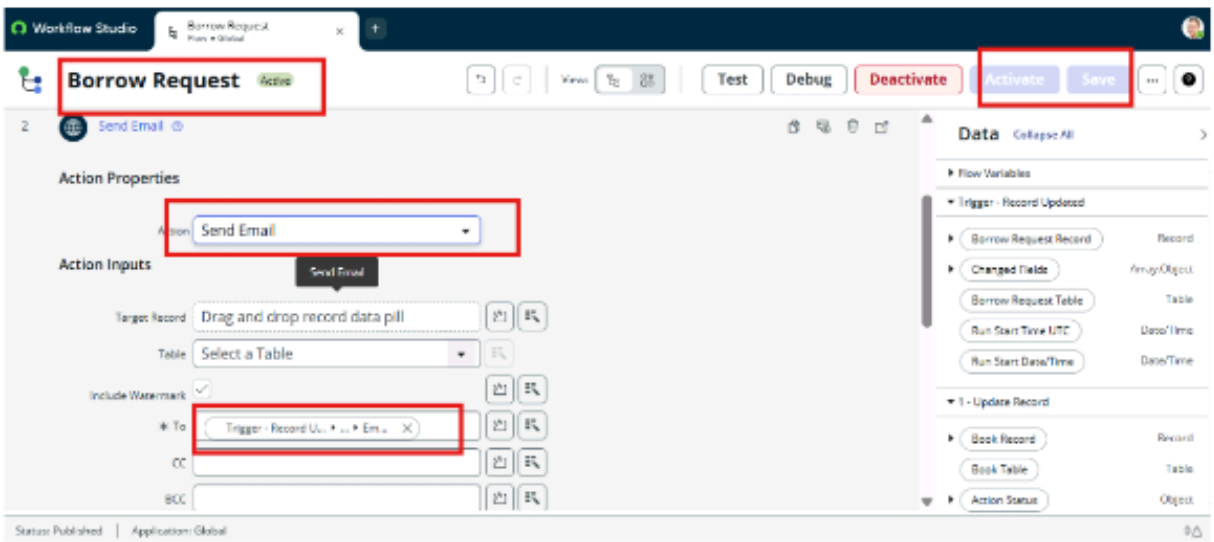
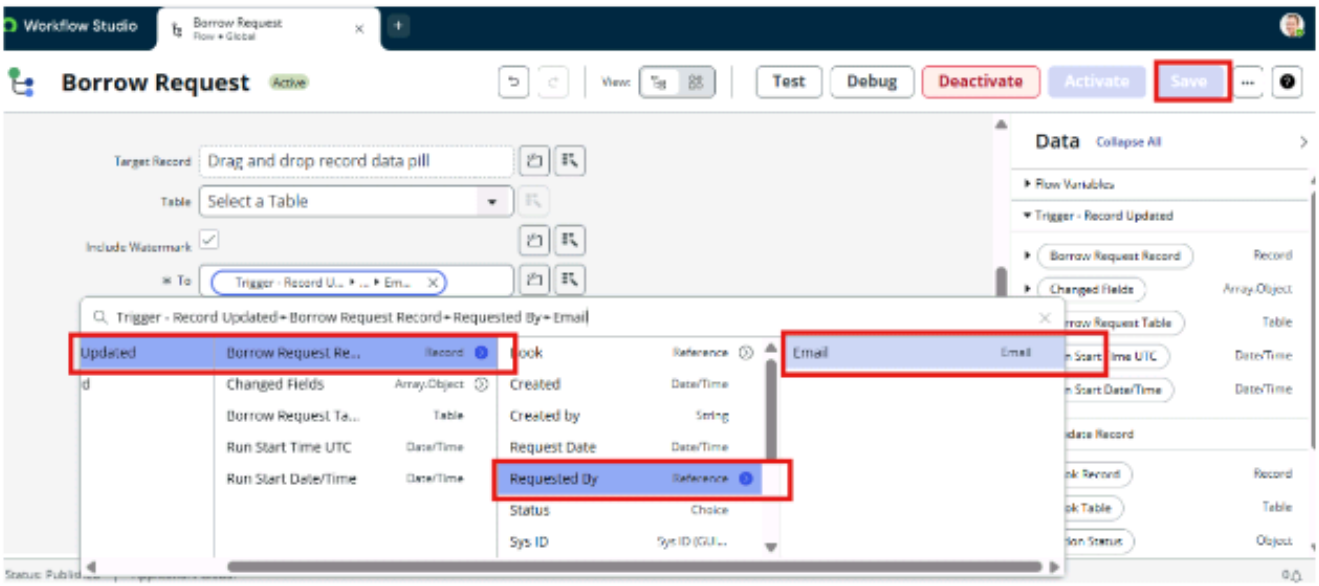
Add Action – Update Borrow Request Record

1. Click on + Add Action.
2. Search for an Update Record.
3. Choose Table = Borrow Request [u_borrow_request].
4. Condition: Sys ID = Current.
5. Set Status = Approved.
6. Click Done.



Add Action – Send Email (Notification)

1. Click on + Add Action.
2. Search for Send Email.
3. Set To = Requested By (Borrow Request → Requested By field).
4. Subject: Your Borrow Request has been Approved.
5. Body: The book [Book.Title] has been issued to you. Please collect it from the library.



Save and Test Flow

1. Click Save → Activate.
2. Create a test Borrow Request with Status = Requested.
3. Verify: Librarian gets approval → On approve, Book.Status = Issued, Borrow Request.Status = Approved, and student receives

Milestone5: **Create UI Policy**

Activity1: **Create UI Policy**

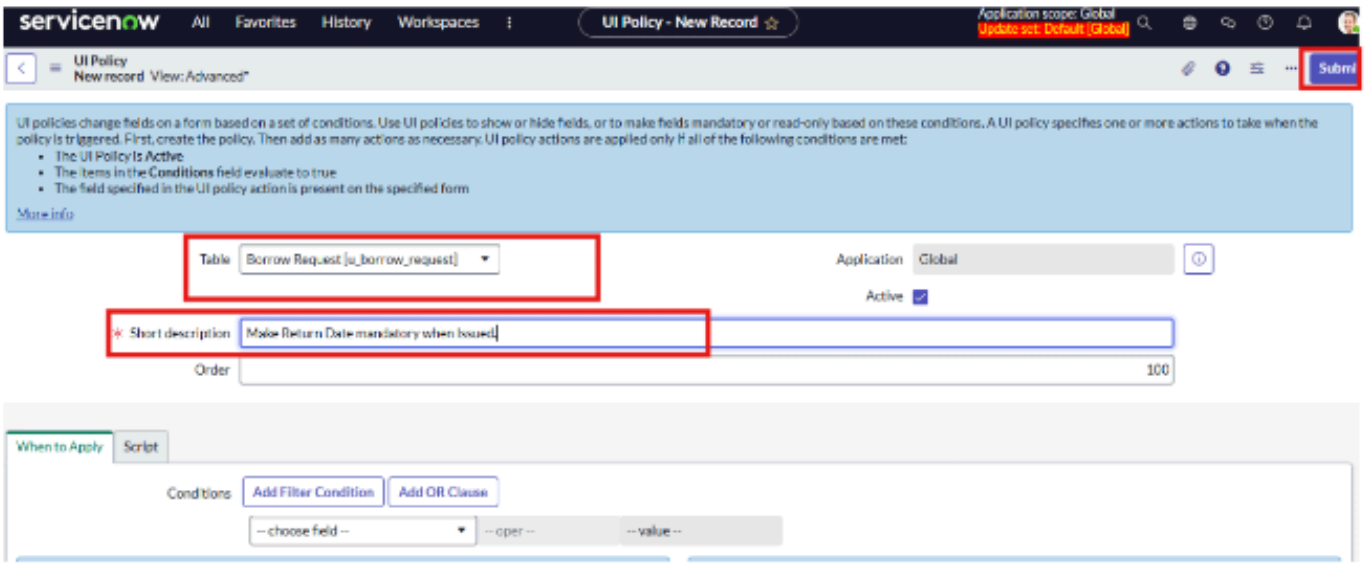
1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All → search for UI Policies.
3. Select System UI → UI Policies.

4.Click on New.

5.Enter Table = Borrow Request u_borrow_request].

6.Enter Short Description = Make Return Date mandatory when Issued.

7.Submit the record.



1. Reopen the created UI Policy record.
2. In the Conditions section, set: Status = Issued.
3. In the UI Policy Actions related list, click New.
4.
5. Select Field = Return Date.
6. Set Mandatory = True.
7. Set Visible = True.
8. Submit the UI Policy Action.

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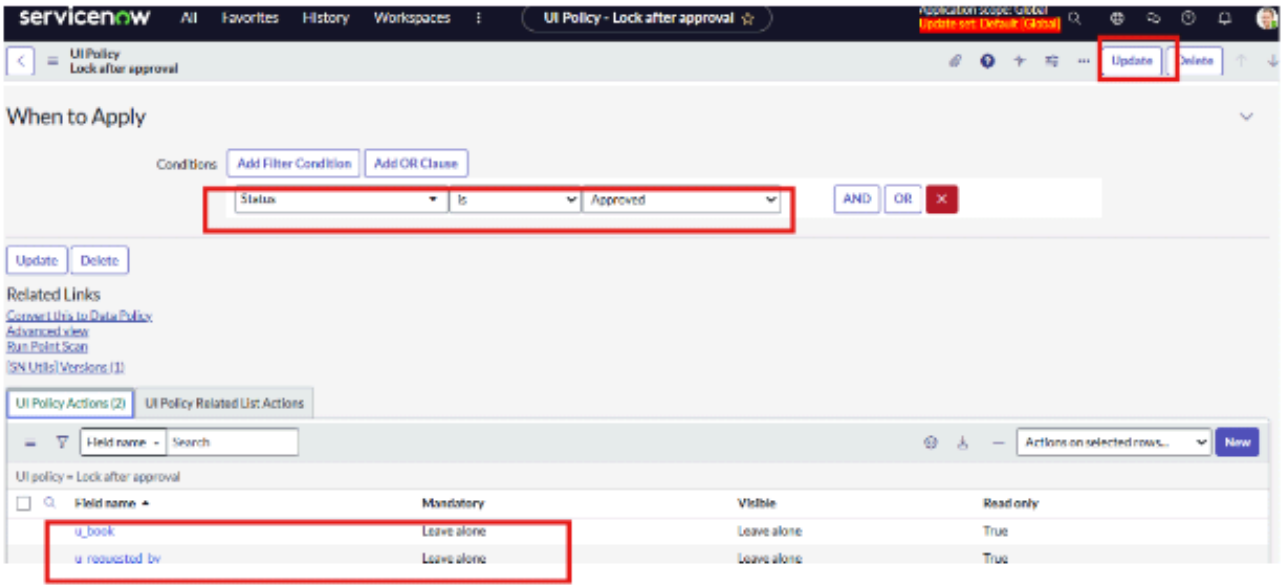


Milestone6: **Create Access Control list**

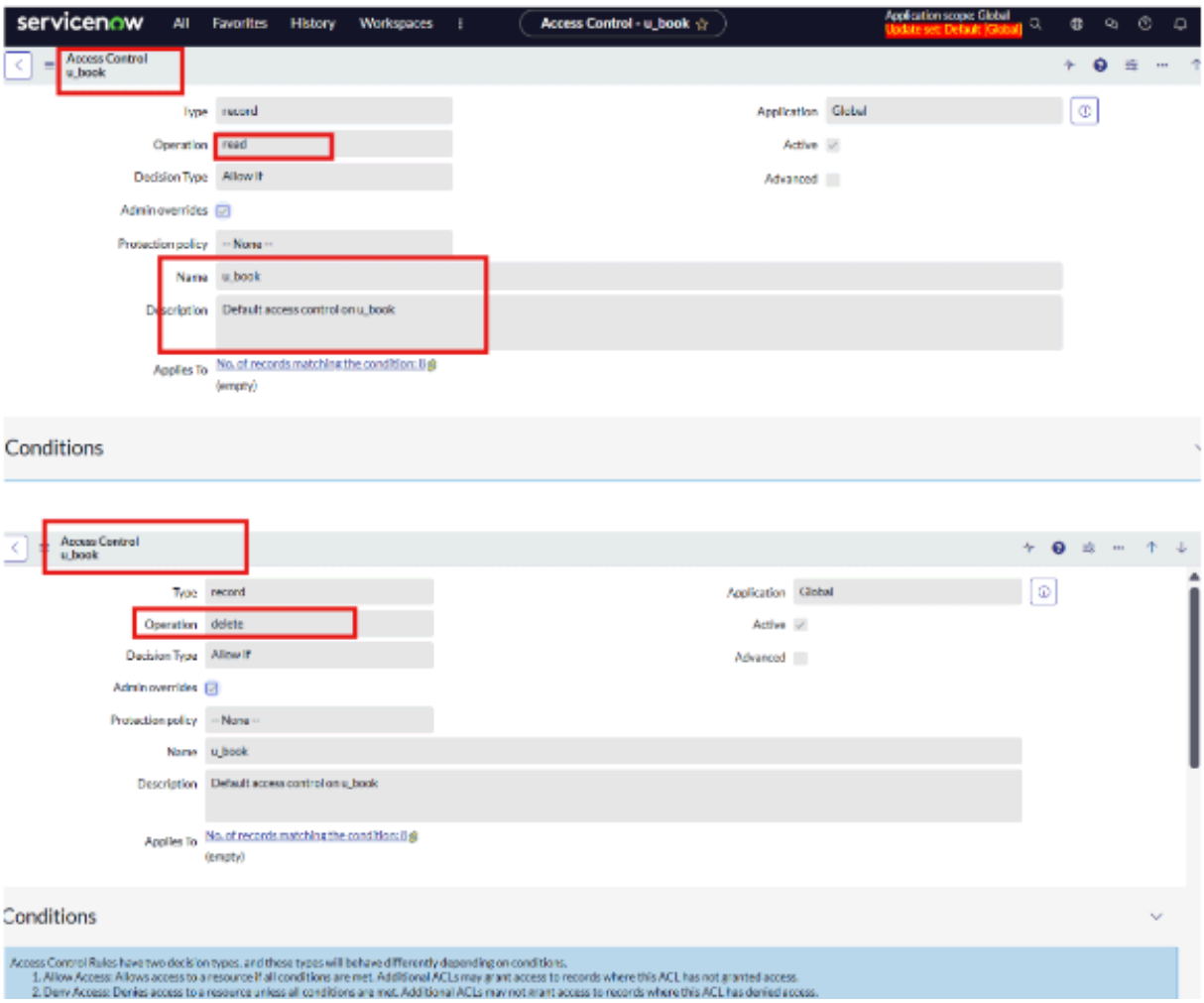
Activity1: **Creation Of ACL**

Access Control for Book Table

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All → search for Access Control.
3. Select System Security → Access Control (ACL).
4. Click New.
5. Select Table = Book [u_book].
6. Choose Operation = read.
7. Set Requires role = student, librarian.
8. Submit.
9. Again, click New.

10.Select Table = Book [u_book].
11.Choose Operation = write.
12.Set Requires role = librarian.

13.Submit.
14.Again, click New.
15.Select Table = Book [u_book].
16.Choose Operation = delete.
17.Set Requires role = librarian.
18.Submit.
Result: Students can only read books, librarians can read, write, and delete.



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Milestone5: **Create Report**

Activity1: Creation of Reports

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All → search for Reports.
3. Select Reports → View / Run.
4. Click on New.
5. Enter Name = Most Borrowed Books.
6. Select Source Type = Table.
7. Select Table = Borrow Request [u_borrow_request].
8. Choose Type = Bar Chart (or Pie Chart as needed).
9. In the Group by field, select Book.
10. In the Aggregate field, select Count.
11. Add a filter: Status = Approved (to count only issued books).
12. Click Run to preview the report.
13. Adjust chart options (Title, Labels, Legend) as required.
14. Click Save. To publish

Conclusion:

The Library Management Project successfully streamlined the process of borrowing and managing books within ServiceNow by integrating role-based access, automated approvals, and dynamic workflows. Students can easily submit barrow requests, while librarians efficiently review, approve, and issue books with proper validations. The solution ensures transparency through status tracking, notifications, and reporting features. By combining automation with usability, the project delivers a scalable foundatio that can be extended to broader academic services in the future.